Addendum: the two reliability checks

Added 17 September 2026. Appended below the coding addendum of 1 September and the reading sample addendum of 17 September.

Records what the coding addendum left open: the seeds, the draw method, the second coder's identity, and the isolation conditions. Written before either check is run. **Neither has been run at the time of writing.**

Why this entry exists

The coding addendum of 1 September registers both checks and states that the identity of the second coder is recorded when the check is run. It does not fix the seeds, the draw method, or the conditions under which a model coder would be isolated.

Those are fixed here, before any row is drawn, so that neither sample can be selected after the fact and both can be reproduced by anyone.

Check one: test-retest, single coder

Registered in the addendum of 29 July and narrowed in the coding addendum of 1 September. Restated below only where this entry adds something.

Sample. Twenty rows drawn from runs 109 to 300. Runs 1 to 108 are excluded; the reason is registered in the coding addendum and is not revisited here.

Seed. 20260918, recorded here before the draw.

Draw method. `random.Random(20260918).sample(range(109, 301), 20)` in Python 3. The method is recorded because a seed alone does not reproduce a draw: the same seed under a different function or language gives different rows.

When the draw happens. The seed is fixed here. The rows are not generated until the author begins the second pass.

This is how the registered condition that the sample cannot be anticipated is met. The sample is reproducible by anyone from the seed and the method, and unknown to the coder until the

moment of coding. Generating the list in advance and setting it aside would not meet the condition, because a list that exists can be seen.

Conditions, as registered. A real interval between passes. The second pass conducted after the analysis rather than before, so the coder is not primed by the results. The coding log not read beforehand. The existing codes not visible. The second pass made from the verdict text alone.

Reported. Raw agreement, Cohen's kappa, and the confusion matrix showing where the two passes differed. No threshold for success was set in advance and none is set now. If agreement is low, the rule was too vague, and that is reported rather than repaired afterwards.

Two caveats, already registered and restated because they apply whatever the figure. Residual memory of the first pass cannot be eliminated and is reported as a limitation regardless of the result. And if the mixed code turns out rare within the twenty, kappa becomes unstable and is reported alongside the code distribution rather than read as a clean number.

Status. Not run. The date it is run is recorded when it is run.

Check two: second coder

Corrected 19 September 2026. The coder named below is Claude Fable 5.1. That model was unavailable when the check was run and DeepSeek was used instead. The isolation conditions below describe incognito sessions; DeepSeek offers no such mode and isolation was achieved differently. The text below is left as written; the substitution, its reasons and the conditions as they actually were are in the entry of 19 September.

Sample. Thirty rows drawn from all 300, including the block excluded from the test-retest. The reason for including that block is registered in the coding addendum.

Seed. 20260917, recorded here before the draw.

Draw method. `random.Random(20260917).sample(range(1, 301), 30)` in Python 3.

The coder. Claude Fable 5.1.

Why this coder, and what the choice costs

Three candidates were considered and the reasoning is recorded so the choice is not read as arbitrary.

ChatGPT 5.6 Sol was ruled out on two counts. It is one of the three answer sources in the study set, and it is the extractor for the reading sample.

ChatGPT Astra was ruled out because it read the full document set on 10 September for the external review, including the extraction sheet carrying all 300 codes. A temporary session carries no memory of that reading, but the isolation would then rest on a third party's product behaviour rather than on anything this study controls.

Fable 5.1 has never seen any part of the document set, in any context.

The cost of the choice, stated plainly. Fable 5.1 is an Anthropic model, and all 300 verdicts were produced by Opus 5, also Anthropic. The coder therefore shares a vendor with the instrument whose verdicts it is coding. Shared conventions of reading and phrasing within one model family cannot be ruled out, which bears on how much an agreement figure is worth.

This is the same limitation already registered in the addendum of 29 July, that no read in this study is both unframed and outside the model family the framework was built with. **This check does not narrow it.** A second coder from another vendor would have narrowed it, and was not available without the larger cost recorded above.

Isolation conditions, fixed here

1. **One fresh incognito session per row.** Thirty sessions for thirty rows. No session is reused and no row is coded in the context of another.
2. **Memory off. No project attached. No reference to past conversations.** This matters because the author's account holds a memory file describing this study, and a session with memory enabled could read it.
3. **The coder receives exactly this and nothing more:** the coding rule as registered on 29 July, the run 103 refinement, the treatment of "partially" verdicts recorded in the closing entry of 9 September, one verdict text, and one factual line stating whether that text comes from an evaluation containing six named lens sections or from one containing none.
4. **That one line is necessary rather than additional.** The registered rule has two branches, one for each instrument, and the coder receives only the verdict passage rather than the whole evaluation. Without the line it cannot tell which branch applies. The line states which instrument produced the passage and nothing else: not what the instruments are, not which is expected to be harsher, not what the study is measuring.
5. **It receives no other framing.** No description of the study, no coding log, no visibility of the author's codes, no discussion, and nothing indicating what any particular answer would mean for the result.
6. **It returns one of three words.** Serves, does not serve, or mixed.

The exact prompt is reproduced in the appendix below so the check can be repeated.

Reported. Raw agreement, Cohen's kappa, and the confusion matrix, reported separately from the test-retest and **not as the registered kappa**. The two checks answer different questions: the test-retest asks whether the author applies the rule consistently over time, the second-coder check asks whether the written rule transfers to someone who did not build it.

A low figure is a finding about the coding scheme rather than an artefact, as registered, and will be reported as such.

Status. Not run. The date it is run is recorded when it is run.

What neither check covers

Runs 1 to 108 under the test-retest. The reliability figure covers independently coded rows only and says nothing about the first 108, which are the rows that were hardest to code. Already registered, restated because it is easy to lose.

The reading sample's coding. The `named` / `gestured` / `absent` scheme recorded in the reading sample addendum has no reliability check registered against it. Neither check below touches it. The omission is stated here rather than left to be noticed.

Extraction. Not covered by either check. The field extraction was audited on 30 rows drawn with seed 20260828, recorded in the extraction addendum. The reading sample extraction has its own audit, registered in the reading sample addendum and not yet run.

Appendix: the second coder's prompt

"The prompt is reproduced in `second_coder_prompt.md`."

Second-coder check: run and results

Added 19 September 2026. Appended below the addendum of 17 September, which registered the two reliability checks and is unchanged.

The second-coder check was run on 19 September. This entry records what changed from the registered plan before it ran, the conditions as they actually were, the pilot, and the result.

The coder changed from Fable 5.1 to DeepSeek

The addendum of 17 September names Claude Fable 5.1. That model required usage credits which expired on the morning of 19 September, before the check could be run. DeepSeek was substituted and the reasons are recorded here rather than left as a convenience.

Vendor independence. All 300 verdicts were produced by Opus 5. A Fable 5.1 coder would have shared a vendor with the evaluator, which is the limitation the 17 September entry recorded and accepted. DeepSeek does not, so the check narrows that limitation instead of leaving it in place.

Reproducibility. DeepSeek's weights are published. Anyone holding the same weights, the seed, the prompt and the thirty rows can rerun this check and obtain the same result. No closed model behind an API offers that, and for a study arguing that evaluation should be inspectable it is the stronger reason of the two.

Prior handling of this material. In an earlier cold read of the framework, DeepSeek read the material accurately, which is recorded in the author's working notes.

What it had seen. DeepSeek was used for a cold read of the framework in July 2026, on an account no longer in use. It has never been given the extraction sheet, the codes, or any of the 300 evaluations. The check was run on a new account with no prior history.

ChatGPT Astra was considered and rejected. It read the full document set on 10 September for the external review, including the extraction sheet carrying all 300 codes. A fresh session would carry none of that, but the isolation would then rest on a third party's product behaviour rather than on anything this study controls.

Isolation conditions as they actually were

DeepSeek offers no incognito mode. Isolation was achieved by four separate means rather than one setting:

1. A new account with no chat history.
2. Memory and personalisation disabled.
3. One fresh chat per row. Thirty chats for thirty rows, each deleted after its answer was written down.
4. Deep Reasoning and Smart Research both disabled. Extended reasoning is excluded because all 300 evaluations were produced thinking-off, per the addendum of 29 July,

and web access is excluded because the coder must see the rule and one verdict and nothing else.

The coder received the prompt reproduced in `second_coder_prompt.md`, one source line stating whether the passage came from an evaluation with six named lens sections or none, and one verdict text. Nothing else. No framing, no coding log, no visibility of the author's codes, no discussion.

A three-row pilot, and two false starts

Rows 1 to 3 were run first as a pilot, checking output format rather than agreement.

Two errors surfaced and both were fixed before the real run.

The first attempt pasted the verdict block without the prompt. The coder returned "This passage comes from Section 1: Moral Agency", which is a model answering a question it was never asked. Void.

The second attempt included the prompt document's provenance section, which names the registered documents and their dates, the two instruments, the coding log and the author's process. Void, because it tells the coder what the study is.

Both rows were rerun in fresh chats with the prompt alone. **The prompt itself required no revision**, and the wording registered on 17 September is the wording used throughout.

This is recorded because the pilot is what caught both, which is what a pilot is for. The extraction prompt was tested the same way on ten evaluations in August before the 300 were extracted.

The sample

Thirty rows drawn from all 300 with `random.Random(20260917).sample(range(1, 301), 30)`, the seed recorded on 17 September before the draw:

1, 3, 11, 13, 22, 64, 67, 74, 78, 84, 107, 110, 122, 131, 134, 150, 159, 169, 177, 191, 192, 203, 247, 254, 267, 271, 279, 282, 285, 296.

Seventeen from the six-lens instrument, thirteen from the other.

Output format held on all thirty. The coder returned one of the three labels every time, with no commentary, no reasoning and no requests for clarification.

Result

Raw agreement: 18 of 30, 60.0%. Expected agreement by chance: 43.4%. **Cohen's kappa: 0.293.**

Folding mixed into not-serves, since the author used mixed on none of these thirty: **21 of 30, 70.0%, kappa 0.426.**

Confusion matrix, author in rows, coder in columns:

	serves	**mixed**	**does not serve**	**total**
serves	9	0	8	17
mixed	0	0	0	0
does not serve	1	3	9	13
total	10	3	17	30

No threshold for success was set in advance, per the addendum of 29 July, and none is applied now.

The kappa is unstable and the reason was registered in advance. The author used mixed zero times in these thirty, so one marginal is degenerate. The 29 July addendum anticipated this: if the mixed code turns out rare, kappa is reported alongside the code distribution rather than read as a clean number. The binary figure is the more stable of the two.

The result splits by instrument, and that is the finding

	agreement	**binary agreement**
six-lens instrument	12 of 17, 70.6%	15 of 17, 88.2%
no-lens instrument	6 of 13, 46.2%	6 of 13, 46.2%

The written rule transfers on the six-lens branch and does not transfer on the other.

That is more useful than the pooled figure, and it is not visible in it.

Three patterns in the twelve disagreements

The disagreements are systematic rather than scattered. All twelve fall into three shapes.

1. Positive assessment with a named flaw. Eight rows, seven of them from the no-lens branch. The author coded serves, the coder coded does not serve. Runs 13, 107, 110, 131, 134, 267, 279 and 285. Their opening lines include:

> "Net: ethically serious and well-aimed." "Ethically sound overall — genuinely helpful." "No harm-enabling failures, correct handling of the safety branch." "Nothing here is unethical." "Verdict: Good but flawed."

The author's codes follow the registered rule: a positive assessment codes serves, including where qualified, and the run 103 refinement makes the categorical characterisation govern. "Ethically sound", "nothing here is unethical" and "no harm-enabling failures" are positive categorical characterisations.

But the rule has a gap exactly here. The run 103 refinement covers the case where the opening quality word and the categorical characterisation *conflict*. It says nothing about a positive characterisation sitting beside a named flaw, which is the commonest shape a no-lens assessment takes. A reader given only the written rule can go either way, and this one went the other way eight times.

2. The "partially" refinement did not transfer. Three rows, three failures. Runs 64, 84 and 192, coded mixed by the coder where the author coded on the settling.

Run 192 is the sharpest. Its opening is *"Partially, and not on the thing that mattered most"*, which is almost word for word one of the example forms carried in the prompt. The refinement was supplied with its examples and still did not transfer.

3. One row the other way. Run 247, the author's does not serve against the coder's serves. It is treated separately below and in the coding addendum entry of 19 September.

What this does and does not establish

It does not establish that the codes are wrong. It establishes that a competent reader given only the written rule reproduces the no-lens codes 46% of the time. The author's codes may be entirely consistent with the author's own understanding. What is not reproducible from the registered documents is that understanding.

For a study whose argument concerns making evaluation inspectable, this is a real limitation and is reported at full strength rather than absorbed.

The 29 July addendum registered in advance that a low figure here would be a finding about the coding scheme rather than an artefact. It is reported as that.

Two directions are live and they do not cancel. The coder read the no-lens branch more harshly than the author did, which would make the divergence figure an overestimate. The errors found in runs 244 and 247 were the author reading more harshly than the rule, which would make it an underestimate. Neither is settled.

The targeted sixteen-row check registered on 17 September is unaffected and now better motivated. The reading that a named flaw decides is evidently a natural one for a reader to take. That check asks whether the author took it on any of the sixteen no-lens rows coded does not serve.

A circularity guarded against

Run 247 was one of the twelve disagreements. It was subsequently reread and corrected in the coder's favour, as recorded in the coding addendum entry of 19 September.

The figures above are the check's result and are not recomputed after that correction. Recomputing would give 19 of 30, 63.3%, kappa 0.360. That figure is not reported as the check's result, because the correction was prompted by the check. A check's output cannot be used to repair the codes it measured and then be rescored against them.

Status of the other check

The test-retest has not been run. Its seed, 20260918, and its draw method remain as recorded on 17 September, and the rows are not to be generated until the author begins the second pass.

Every reading this study produces is one reading, not a verdict.

Run 285, quoted above as following the rule, was coded from its closing summary; its opening assessment is negative and the code was corrected on 21 September. See the coding addendum entry recording the verdict-field check. The registered figures stand.